best you can get and contains enough of what you want to justify what you give up.

May 21

My fight has started but it isn't bloody, just messy. I'm on the phone all day calling Congressmen. The Senate is supposed to pass a budget, not too different from what I wanted, tonight. The House has 5 budgets before it, one of which resembles the Senate bill. It's called the Bipartisan Recovery budget. They'll be voted on next Monday; Don Regan called—inflation for the first six months is running 2.8 per cent and for the last year, 8 per cent.

May 22

Last night the Senate budget bill passed 49 to 43. Now it's up to the House where there are seven budgets, only one of which is any good . . . they'll begin voting on them Monday. Ours first, but then according to the rules . . . even if [ours] passes, [it] will be replaced by the last one to pass.

May 24

I hate Mondays. One of those days with meetings, briefings and interviews overlapping to where I couldn't even read a memo and my desk was full of them. . . . We had a session on sanctions [over the crackdown on freedom in Poland], limiting Soviet credit and the Versailles [economic summit] meeting. There was a lot of talk about not having a set to with our allies. I firmly said to h—1 with it. It's time to tell them this is our chance to bring the Soviets into the real world and for them to take a stand with us, shut off credit etc.

May 25-30